



DPL 2026 · OFFICIAL DOCUMENT

DPL 2026 **RULE BOOK**

Official Match Rule Book

Digitate Premier League · Office Cricket

October 7–8, 2026 · DPL Arena

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SECTION 1

Team Composition

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- 1.1** A squad must consist of 15 players, including:
- 1 Owner
 - 1 Captain
 - 2 Female Players (Both of them must be in the playing 9).
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- 1.2** The Owner is allowed to play in the matches.
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- 1.3** The Owner and Captain will be the sole points of contact for organizers, volunteers, and umpires.
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- 1.4** Captain can be changed after Auction for match day. (Should be informed to BCCD prior to tournament.)
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- 1.5** Two female players must be part of the playing squad (9 players in total).
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- 1.6** If a team has less than 9 players on match day, they will have to play with number of available players only.
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- 1.7** If a replacement player is needed during a match (only for special cases if any), organizers or volunteers will provide a player, upon request from the Owner or Captain. [Considering spirit of game.]
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- 1.8** Once the auction is completed, no player may switch teams or play for more than one team.
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- 1.9** All players are expected to play in the spirit of the game and are solely responsible for their actions. TCS will not be liable for player behavior.
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Playing Rules

- 2.1** Each inning will consist of 5 overs.
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- 2.2** No bowler may bowl more than one over per inning. First overs must be bowled by a female player.
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- 2.3** A female player will be taking strike as opener.
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- 2.4** The female player batting will not be allowed to bowl in the same match and vice versa. (If only 1 female player is available – team will play with 8 players only. Extra 25 runs penalty will be rewarded to the opponent team.)
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- 2.5** Top 2 male batters not allowed to bowl in same match. (Those who are going to bowl will be able to bat No.4 onwards)
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- 2.6** A coin toss will determine whether the winning team chooses to bat or bowl first.
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Dismissal Modes for Batter

- 3.1** All standard modes of dismissal apply: Bowled, Caught, Stumped, Run Out, Handling the Ball, and Mankading.
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- 3.2** A "one tip, one hand" catch is considered out for all batters. (No body support) Female fielders can use both hands for such catches.
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- 3.3** If ball has touched to body directly, and then tip on ground – then one tip catch is not considered.
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- 3.4** LBW is not applicable.
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- 3.5** A batsman is out if the ball is hit directly outside the playing area (i.e., a six is out).
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- 3.6** If the ball goes outside the playing area after touching a fielder or bowler, it is not out; it counts as 4 runs.
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- 3.7** For a run out, the wicket must be broken with the ball in hand (not with any part of the body).
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- 3.8** Hit Wicket: Not applicable to female players. If a female player hits the wicket while batting, the runs scored will be awarded, and it is considered a legal ball.
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No Ball & Free Hit and Extras

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- 4.1** Bowlers must remain within the designated box when bowling.
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- 4.2** A no-ball will be called if the bowler touches / crosses either side of the box / line.
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- 4.3** No-ball results in a Free Hit. On a Free Hit, the batsman cannot be dismissed except for a run-out.
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- 4.4** If the ball is hit out of the playing area on a no-ball or Free Hit delivery, it counts as 4 runs. (No runs on Six) (No wickets)
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- 4.5** A no-ball or wide on a Free Hit result in another Free Hit.
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- 4.6** A no-ball will be called if the ball bounces over the batsman's shoulder height; this will be followed by a warning, and subsequent similar deliveries will be called no balls.
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- 4.7** A ball directly over the batsman's waist height without bouncing will also be called a no-ball.
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- 4.8** If the wicketkeeper collects the ball in front of the stumps on a missed Free Hit, it will be called a no-ball.
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- 4.9** Batsmen cannot be stumped on a Free Hit delivery.
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- 4.10** One run is awarded for every no-ball bowled.
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- 4.11** Four runs will be awarded on each ball after three dead balls / no balls / wide balls in an over. (Ball will be counted)
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- 4.12** No runs can be scored for Dead Ball. (1st 3 dead balls of the over)
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Bowling Action

5.1 Underarm bowling is not allowed.

5.2 Bowling Action Details -

- a. Arm Extension Above the Head: The bowler's arm should not extend above the top of the head while delivering the ball. This rule helps ensure that the bowler's action is legal and fair.
 - b. Elbow Behind the Back: The elbow should not be positioned behind the back during the delivery. This could indicate an illegal action such as throwing rather than bowling, which is prohibited.
 - c. Arm Movement Behind the Ear: The arm must not move behind the ear, which is a key part of ensuring a legal bowling action.
 - d. Legs should be placed parallel: The leg should be placed parallel. While throwing the bowl, heel / toe can be moved, but leg should not be lifted completely. Stepping is not allowed.
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5.3 Exception for Female Players: Above rules a, b, c and d are not applicable for Female Players.

5.4 A sideways bowling action is not allowed.

5.5 Full hand rotation during bowling is not allowed.

5.6 Bowlers must keep both feet grounded and inside the box while delivering the ball. Lifting the leg will result in a no-ball. (legs can be kept in any position)

Injuries and Retiring

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- 6.1** A batsman cannot retire hurt unless injured, and this decision will be made by the umpire.
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- 6.2** A runner will not be allowed for any player unless approved by the umpire.
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- 6.3** Batsmen will automatically retire after scoring 25 runs in an inning.
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- 6.4** The retired batsman may return to bat only after all other players are either out or retired.
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- 6.5** Any breach of these guidelines is considered a No Ball, and the bowler will be penalized as per No balls rules. This is a measure to ensure fairness and safety in the game.
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- 6.6** If a player is retired due to injury, they can be substituted in the match from the squad. (Score will be marked on retired players name)
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- 6.7** Female player batter can opt to retire after 1st over completion. (Retirement call will be voluntary, to be taken by Female player only.)
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- 6.8** Female player cannot opt to retire if call is not taken after 1st over. (Only 1 chance of voluntary retirement will be given to female player.)
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- 6.9** Retired players can come back to bat if all players are out.
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SECTION 7

Fielding Restrictions

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- 7.1** A wicketkeeper is mandatory for the fielding side.
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- 7.2** Keeper change and bowling side not needed to be informed to umpire.
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- 7.3** Bowling side change can be informed to umpire only in between over.
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- 7.4** The fielding side and batting side must inform player information to scorers before starting and during batter change. If not, will be considered as No Ball.
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SECTION 8

Scoring

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- 8.1** A ball that goes outside the boundary after bouncing inside the field is considered to have 4 runs.
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- 8.2** A no-ball or wide results in 1 run being awarded to the batting team. (Till 3 illegal balls[No ball / wide ball / dead ball] are delivered in an over.)
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- 8.3** After 3 illegal deliveries, next illegal ball should be considered as 4 bye runs. (ball counted)
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- 8.4** Overthrow runs will be awarded as per general cricket rules.
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- 8.5** If the ball goes behind the decided line behind the wicketkeeper and stumps after touching the bat, no runs are allowed, but runs are permitted if it touches a fielder or in case of an overthrow.
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Women Player Scoring

- 9.1** Captains must declare a female player's role (who will bat and who will bowl) from their team during toss.
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- 9.2** Runs scored by the designated female player (by bat) will be doubled (1 run = 2 runs, 2 runs = 4 runs, etc.), except in the case of a Super Over (in case of a tie).
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Misbehavior and Decision Making

- 10.1** Players who misbehave with umpires or volunteers may be banned from the tournament, either individually or with their entire team.
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- 10.2** In cases of ambiguity, the field umpires, volunteers, and organizers will make the final decision.
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Communication

- 11.1** Only the team captain is allowed to communicate with the umpires regarding any issues or queries. No other player may engage in one-on-one communication with the umpires.
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Tie Breaker

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- 12.1** In case of a tie, a Super Over will be played.
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- 12.2** Only 3 batsmen are allowed to bat in the Super Over (2 wickets).
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- 12.3** The team batting second during the regular match will bat first in the Super Over.
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- 12.4** Scoring rules for female players during the regular match will not apply in the Super Over.
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Additional Conditions

- 13.1 The ball used will be light tennis ball.
- 13.2 Teams can bring their own bats. Some kits will be available.
- 13.3 The coordinators will provide the wickets.

Responsibility

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- 14.1** Owners and captains are responsible for ensuring their teams understand and follow these rules. All teams must acknowledge that they have thoroughly read the rules in advance.
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- 14.2** Owners and captains must coordinate with their teams to ensure players are present for matches. If a team runs out of players (including extras), they must inform the organizers a day before the match so a replacement can be arranged. Only one replacement per team is allowed. Once replaced, a player cannot return to their team or play for another team.
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- 14.3** All associates must adhere to the TCS Code of Conduct and play the game with a positive spirit.
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ALL THE BEST TO ALL THE TEAMS FOR DPL 2026

Owners and captains are responsible for ensuring their teams understand and follow these rules. All teams acknowledge that they have read the rule book in advance.

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